Vatsyayana (350–400 CE), author of the *Nyaya-Bhashya*; *Uddyotakara* (550–600 CE), author of the *Nyayavarttika*; *Vachaspati Mishra* (800–50 CE), author of the *Tatparyatika*; *Jayanta Bhatta* (850–900 CE), author of the *Nyayamanjari*; *Bhasarvajna* (900–50 CE), author of the *Nyayasara* and *Nyayabhushana*; and ***Udayana***.

Nyaya theorists are direct realists about perception and hold that whatever exists is in principle knowable. All there really is is open to observation, either directly (***pratyaksha***) or indirectly (***anumana***, and testimony or *shabda*). The world is basically how it appears to commonsense. It causes our perceptions. Cognitions (***jnana***) are always and only the manifestation of mind-independent realities (including perceptible universals and relations) outside the mind. A cognitive episode may grasp the same physical object by the senses (***indriya***) of sight and touch when they are coordinated by the mind (***manas***). This concurrence proves both the integrated unity of the whole object (***avayavin***) and the identity of the continuous subject to which perceptions attach. The soul (***atman***) is an immaterial but essentially non-conscious principle of continuity. But it has the capacity to become temporarily the substrate of cognitive episodes, feelings and acts of will.

A cognition is not self-aware but requires a subsequent cognition (***anuvyavasaya***) to reveal it. This rejection of reflexivity is consistent with the insistence that we are primarily aware of a world outside the mind and not our ideas.

They hold that to be in a state of knowledge, it is not necessary that one actually knows that one knows. What is necessary is that one's true belief should have been arrived at by a reliable method.

The reliable means of knowledge (***pramana***) are: perception (***pratyaksha-pramana***), which is basic to our